



Wāndyr

an Adventure Game



Wåndyr, an Adventure Game

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About the Name: Wåndyr is “wander” as in travel about, but also “wonder” as in finding wondrous things in your travels, and maybe bringing them back.

Welcome to Wåndyr!

Wåndyr is an adventure game about a band of adventurers wandering through a pulp fantasy world. The focus is on exploration, following rumors, discovering places, treasure hunting, camping, singing, storytelling, cleverly overcoming impossible odds, naming weapons, and coming back alive with tales to tell. In the spirit of *The Hobbit*, Wåndyr celebrates the journey of going there and back again.



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Starting a Game

Get together with friends. One is the Guide, the others are players.

1 - Starting Location

The Guide describes the starting location for the adventure, such as a medieval tavern in a town on the borderlands. The Guide can place this into a larger fantasy world, or let that be a mystery for now.

2 - Create Characters

Create three characters, each with an alias, 2 Traits and 2 Skills:

SYR TIRIEL: PIOUS, KNIGHT | POLEAX, ARMOR

LINDON: SHARP-EYED, SCOUT | LONGBOW, AX

HELIÖN: STRONG, HALE | MACE, SHIELD

MEMNETH: FIERY, ENERGETIC | ELEMENTALE, STAFF

BEL: FRIENDLY, BARD | CANTING, LUTE



3 - Select a Rumor

The Guide lists three rumors that hint about troublesome events or

mysterious places to explore. Choose one rumor to follow now.

4 - Muster a Character

Roll 2d6 Hearts for each of your three characters to see how they are feeling today, then choose one to "Muster" (play). From now on, you play as your mustered character.

5 - Pack for the Journey

The Guide will provide you with a few "hand me down" items such as weapons, armor, spellbooks, etc. The Guide may also provide travel supplies (e.g. food, water, cloak).

6 - Embark

The Guide will narrate the start of your journey and provide a landmark or general directions so the path forward is clear. You play your mustered character; the Guide handles everything else.



Characters

Each character starts with an alias, two Traits and two Skills. The Traits are how you play the character, and the Skills are what the character knows how to do.

For example, "Rook: agile cunning | knife, (lockpicks)" goes by the alias "Rook", should be played as "agile and cunning", and knows how to use a knife and (secretly) lockpicks.

Traits

A Trait is a keyword that describes how your character is played. *This is perhaps more important than it sounds.* This is not about what your character knows or can do, but more about how they behave. For example, a character with the "bard" Trait *acts* like a musician or skald, while Skills determine what they know how to do. You can think of these as "soft skills" that complement their "hard" Skills.

Guidelines: Each Trait must be a single word, or common compound word (e.g. "rat-catcher", "horse-thief"). Traits can describe physical appearance, personality, quirks, habits, customs, idioms, approach to solving problems, etc. Traits can refer to a culture, homeland, or ancestry (human, elf, dwarf, etc.) or whatever helps you paint a picture. Good Traits make

the character memorable and fun to play.



Skills

A Skill is something the character has learned, either an item proficiency or a knowledge. Examples: dagger, longsword, bow, lockpicks, shield, armor, type of animal, spellbook, wand, arcane staff, harp, bushcraft, etc. You can think of these as "hard skills", or technical knowledge. Skills are not about personality or behavior, but about what the character knows how to do.

Guidelines: Each Skill must be a single word, or common compound word corresponding to a type of item or knowledge (e.g. "greatsword", "herbal medicine").

Specialized Skills: Using specialized items or knowledge requires a specialized or rare Skill, such as "greatsword", "herbal medicine", or a magic school.

Example Characters

Choose or roll d66, or mix n' match parts. The format is **ALIAS: TRAITS | SKILLS**, with Songs in quotes.

1.1 **ROOK:** AGILE CUNNING | KNIFE, (LOCKPICKS)

1.2 **CIPHER:** CALCULATING ELUSIVE | CIPHERS,
DAGGERS

1.3 **SHADOW:** SILENT (RUTHLESS) | BLOWGUN,
POISONS

1.4 **WILDE:** CHARMING STRONG | CARDS, CUTLASS

1.5 **LYRA:** NIMBLE (SPY) | ROPE, SPY CIPHERS

1.6 **PEARL:** DEADLY NOBLE | DISGUISE KIT,
(STILETTO)

2.1 **SERRA:** FIERCE SHIELDMAIDEN | BATTLE AX,
SHIELD

2.2 **MAGNUS:** STRONG, BOISTEROUS | WARHAMMER,
ARMOR

2.3 **IRON:** TOUGH DWARF | AXE, SHIELD

2.4 **SARGE:** GRIZZLED SOLDIER | ARMING SWORD,
ARMOR

2.5 **PIKE:** ALERT GUARD | HALBERD, WHISTLE

2.6 **SHIRO:** HONORABLE LETHAL | KATANA,
WAKIZASHI

3.1 **DRAKE:** WEATHERED WANDERER | MACHETE,
TINDERBOX

3.2 **SLATE:** OBSERVANT SCOUT | TELESCOPE, BOW

3.3 **WOLF:** (FERAL) HUNTER | SPEAR, "SONG OF THE
WILD"

3.4 **HAWK:** VIGILANT SCOUT | LONGBOW,
FALCONRY-GLOVE

3.5 **STORM:** IMPETUOUS, DARING | JAVELIN,
GRAPNEL

3.6 **ECHO:** HALLOW ELF | HARP | "ELVEN BALLAD OF
HOPE"

4.1 **KAT:** LITHE SECOND-STORY-THIEF | (GRAPPLING
HOOK, THIEVES TOOLS)

4.2 **FORGE:** STEADFAST ARMORER | ARMOR,
HAMMER

4.3 **QUILL:** METICULOUS LEARNED | LEDGER, INKWELL

4.4 **FLINT:** STEELY DWARF | AXE, COOKPOT

4.5 **NAILS:** TOUGH SOLDIER | FLAIL, GAMBESON

4.6 **LINDON:** BRAVE, STRONG | POLEAX, ARMOR

5.1 **KHAEL:** FOCUSED WITCH-HUNTER |
UMBRAKALLA BINDING CHAINS

5.2 **VESPER:** ARTISTIC SCHOLAR | ILLUSIONE STAFF

5.3 **TWILIGHT:** PENSIVE DEVIOUS | UMBRAKALLA
SICKLE

5.4 **ISTAR:** HONORABLE WHITE-WIZARD | VITAE
STAFF

5.5 **HEZEREK:** AMBITIOUS (SHADY) | UMBRAKALLA
ORB

5.6 **IGNUS:** FIERY DRIVEN | ELEMENTALE STAFF

6.1 **DUSK:** HONORABLE NOBLE | ANCESTRAL BLADE,
DOUBLET

6.2 **OAK:** STRONG ENDURING | STAFF, ROPE

6.3 **VALE:** WOODCRAFT HUNTER | LONGBOW, KNIFE

6.4 **DIGS:** DWARF PROSPECTOR | PICKAXE, MINING
HELMET

6.5 **BEAR:** STRONG WARRIOR | MAUL, BEARSKIN
CLOAK

6.6 **THALIA:** KEEN-EYED ELF | BOW, SWORD

The Muster

Ok boys, check your kit, check your weapons, it's today. You get a pint and a chaser, no more. Let's go

Hearts

Roll 2d6 Hearts for each of your three characters to see how they feel today. Choose one character to Muster (play) today.

Equipment

You have **10 Item Slots** for readily equipped gear such as armor, weapons, light, and magic items. Most items use one slot; larger items use multiple slots.

Baggage

Anything beyond your 10 Item Slots is "Baggage", which limits movement and may prevent safely swimming, climbing, leaping, etc.

Hands: You can carry items in your hands beyond your 10 Item Slots. For example, you could carry a polearm, throwing ax, or torch. *You'll have to drop them to quickly free up your hands.*

On Your Body: You can carry items hands free by wearing a rucksack, haversack, satchel, etc. Dropping Baggage takes 1 Round (10 seconds), but accessing items inside takes 1 Turn (10 minutes).



Item Slot Examples

Small Items: coin pouch 1, water skin 1, lockpicks 1

Weapons: dagger 1, sword 2, longsword 3, greatsword 4, halberd 4, pike 5

Armor: gauntlets 1, helm 1, gambeson 2, coat of plates 3, full brigandine 4

Shields: buckler 1, heater 2, round shield 3, tower shield 4

Bows: arrow quiver 1, bow 2, crossbow 3, arbalest 4

Musical Instrument: voice 1, pipe 1, lute 2, guitar 3, drum 4

Clothing: shirt 1, pants 1, boots 1, cloak 1, hat 1, ring 1, formal attire 2, cold gear 3

Light: torch 1, oil flask 1, lantern 1, tinderbox 1, firewood 3

Rations: 1 slot per day

Animals: cat 1, hawk 1, dog 2, war dog 3, horse 4

Playing the Game

The game mostly consists of a conversation around the table. The Guide describes the world and people in it other than your characters.

You can have your character attempt anything you want. The Guide decides what happens, or consults the Oracle.

The Oracle

The Oracle answers any yes/no question. Roll 2d6: on 8 or higher the answer is "Yes", otherwise "No".

Easy/Hard: The Oracle number won't always be 8; the Guide will adjust it based on the situation. The range is 6-12: easy (6), normal (8), hard (10), or extreme (12).

Sweet and Spicy

If any die rolls a 6 or a 1, add a twist! 6s are Sweet (good surprises) and 1s are Spicy (not-so-good surprises). Doubles are stronger.

Example: An archer snipes a sentry. On "sweet" the uniform is spotless; on "spicy" another guard notices.

The Guide can interpret the twist or allow you to provide your own interpretation. Unless the twist is

straightforward and minor, ask the Oracle if it happens. *You must ante Hearts to attempt any kind of superhuman/magical stunt.*



Who Asks?

Your character can try anything! When you say your character attempts a direct action, then you roll to ask the Oracle if it happens:

Otherwise, the Guide rolls, especially for unestablished facts:

Tip: Phrase the question from a character perspective, where they hope for "Yes". For example, "Do we find shelter?" is better than "Does the storm catch us?" so that a high roll (e.g. 5+6) results in "yes".

Insight

Each Turn, have someone roll d6 for Insight:

1. **Trait**
2. **Skill**
3. **Item**
4. **Name**
5. **Morale**
6. **Effort**

For each roll this Turn, if you match the criteria then roll with Advantage (3d6, drop lowest).

Trait: your approach matches a Trait

Skill: you use a helpful Skill

Item: you use a helpful item
(special items need special Skills)

Name: you invoke a relevant Name
(item name, byname, or song)

Morale: your party has at least 1
Morale Heart

Effort: you push harder (not possible with Baggage, stealth, climbing, swimming, wrestling, or when making it look easy)

Guide Tip: Call for an Insight roll at the beginning of each combat Round to make the fight feel more lively. Skip this during a pause in action, parley, mop-up, etc.

Disadvantage

A Disadvantage may apply for various factors, such as being unarmed, encumbered, poor position/visibility, firing a bow into or out of melee, etc. If you have Disadvantage then roll 3d6 and drop the highest. *Advantage cancels Disadvantage.*

Deeper Questions

If you need more than yes/no, the Oracle can play "20 questions". The Guide should also use random tables from OSR or those in the **Wândyr World Oracle**.

Guide Tip: Ask an AI to generate a table, then proof it, and then have a player roll on it.

Morale

Your character Hearts keep your character wandering, but Morale keeps your party together.

Morale Hearts

Morale Hearts are a shared party resource; anyone in the party can use Morale Hearts in place of their own character Hearts.

Your party gains Morale Hearts at Muster for Comforts, and can replenish them with Music & Pets.

Comforts

The comforts of home are cheerful companions. A wheel of cheese, a crusty bread, mead, wine, or a good smoke can make even the most dismal dungeon feel fine.

Comforts are high-end provisions such as fine wine, spices, or fresh game. You can purchase them in town (about 10gp each) or hunt/forage in the wild. Some Comforts might only be rare gifts, such as *elven waybread*.

Each Comfort shared during Muster is worth 1 Morale Heart, up to a limit of 1 Morale Heart per player. *You can increase the limit by 1 if you have a relevant Trait/Skill: chef, cook, cooking, herbalism, etc.*



Music

Music is important because it makes everything better.

Performance: You can play music to restore Morale Hearts once per Muster. The performance takes about an hour and restores 1 Morale Heart per character who participates; they will each need a musical instrument and Skill.

Bards: If you keep a musical instrument equipped in Item Slots continuously from Muster, you are a "bard". You may restore 1 Morale Heart as an Action, limited to the instrument Item Slots per Muster. You can alternatively use a music Action to influence NPCs.

Pets

If you have a pet, they can replenish 1 Morale Heart per Item Slot the pet occupies per Muster. (Takes 1 Turn.)

Camp

The game starts with Muster and ends or pauses in Camp. When you decide to stop and rest, you must choose whether to make a temporary camp or return to a prior camp. The game is then paused until the next Muster.

Camp Followers

Anyone not in the Muster can follow along behind to set up the next camp. You can generally fast-travel between your camps.

Home Base

At some point you may decide to establish a permanent camp or "home base", such as a cave, frontier tower, tavern, or hideout. This gives you a secure place to store loot. You can have multiple bases, making fast-travel even more useful.

Equipment

Wândyr assumes a traditional fantasy economy using gold pieces (gp), where quaint medieval items are available for sale in towns.

Equipment Price Guide

Common items cost 1gp per item slot. Examples: clothing, rations, tools, etc.

Armaments cost 5gp per item slot. Examples: weapons, armor, shields, arrows.

Niche items cost 10gp per item slot. Examples: books, music instruments, lockpicks, and unusual munitions.

Masterwork items are +1 and cost an extra 100gp. Add weapon plus to damage and armor plus to Iron Hearts. Grandmasterwork are +2, 1,000gp, and rare.

Elevated items cost an extra 10gp for "good", 100gp "rich", 1,000gp for "noble", and so on.

Magic items have a magical feature. Elven boots silence footsteps, a hero's belt bestows strength, and a magic shield is more protective. You can usually discover its enchantment through use, especially with Skill in the item. Magic items are rarely sold.

Experience

New characters are unproven, untested novices with no prior experience, or heroic deeds. All this must develop during the game.

You will earn 1-6 Experience Points (XP) after following your selected rumor to its full conclusion and returning to camp.

You can also earn small spot bonuses of 1 XP for deeds important in Wandyr: discovering an important new location or magical feature, mapping a new region, experimenting with magic, or rescuing captives. *Slaying monsters and looting treasure never directly earns XP.*

Spending XP

New Traits and Skills cost 3 XP each. The following advancements might also be available if you meet their requirements, 3 XP each. *XP can only be spent in camp.*

Item Name

Once an item has served you well in a significant deed, you can give it a Name. For example, after narrowly slaying a horrid troll you might name your sword "Trollbane". Item Names count for Insight: Name. *An artisan can inscribe the Name and add decorations (inlays, etchings, jewels, gold leaf, gold pommel, etc.).*

Byname

A "byname" is a personal epithet, noble title, or True Name gained through epic deeds. For example, after slaying a dragon, you might earn "Dragonslayer", "the Bold", or "Hero of Ravenwald". Bynames count for Insight: Name. *Bynames are usually given to you rather than something you pick for yourself.*

Song

A "song" is deeply moving work that can inspire others and improve morale. Songs count for Insight: Name.

Spell

After you successfully cast a 1st level spell from a book, *with Sweet*, you can pay 3 XP to "learn" that spell. The spell's *words of power* leave the book and take up residency in your mind and/or body, allowing you to cast it without the book. Your "caster level" in a spell school is your total number of spells "known". *If you find a spell that is higher than 1st level, you will have a harder time casting it, will need a minimum caster level, and learning it will cost more than 3 XP.*

Arcana

You can pay 3 XP to enchant an item with a known spell. This requires the spellbook from which you learned the spell.

Relic

You can pay 3 XP to create a Relic, a conduit to an otherworldly being.

You will need a *True Name* for the being.

Feat

Once you have performed an epic heroic feat in play, you can claim it as a signature move, a "Feat".

Character Level

Your "Character Level" is the number of Traits you've earned. Since you started with two Traits, it's the count of Traits minus two.

The Guide can use character Level for setting the Oracle target. If the characters have a "party leader" the Guide can use their Level instead.

The Guide might alternatively ask for the number of Skills you've earned when hard knowledge is more appropriate, and magic-users have a different level for each magic school based on their number of spells known.

Sandbox Play

The Guide describes the world and serves to answer your questions. The Guide consults existing "lore" (their memory/notes about established facts) and the Oracle for anything else.

The local area remains wide open and undefined, even if some aspects of the wider world are known (or even part of a well-defined setting). This "sandbox"

or "emergent play" style allows everyone at the table to discover the unexpected together. The Guide is also a player!

The Guide does not prepare a predefined story beforehand. Instead, the Guide uses dice rolls and random tables to determine what happens. Each new discovery is a surprise to everyone and adds to the growing lore of your campaign world. Even a well-defined world space for local development.

Time

To add a sense of urgency, the Guide tracks 10-minute "Turns" using a "Turn Clock". This can be a glass or metal bowl in the middle of the table. The Guide loudly tosses a die into the clock each time you do something time-consuming. When the bowl is full with all six dice, an hour has passed; the Guide empties it and rolls the dice. Any 1's indicate a spicy complication such as a wandering monster or guard. The Guide also rolls the Turn Clock when you do something reckless.

Combat Rounds

In combat, time is measured in 10-second "Rounds". This is just enough time for each character to move and take one action. The Turn Clock is usually paused in combat.

Mågic

Wåndyr is full of magic, and much of the game is about exploring and meddling with magical secrets.

All magic in Wåndyr involves *True Names*, either written or spoken as words of power.

Magic items and magical objects bear mystical inscriptions: sharp dwarven runes, flowing elven script, or shifting arcane glyphs, only decipherable by *magic-users*. If you have the correct magic school Skill you can read these words, else, they are just chicken scratch.



Magic-Users

If you have a Skill in a Magic School, you are a "magic-user" of that school. You are literate in the magic language and abstruse practices of that school.

Magic Schools

Magic is classified by "magic school". Words are magical, and magic is formed by magic words, runes, glyphs, arcane script, etc.

Each magic school is a Skill; the major schools are:

1. Vitae (Life)
2. Elementale (Elemental)
3. Thaumaturgy (Control)
4. Illusione (Illusion)
5. Umbrakallo (Shadow Gates)
6. Necromantia (Death)
7. Canting (Thievery)

Each Magic School has its own list of spells and secret magic language, written, verbal, and somatic.

Spell Casting

If you are a magic-user, you can use an Action to cast a spell. You must say the spell name and what you want the spell to do.

Saying what you want to do is especially important in Wåndyr since each spell consists solely of its name. You may not describe

something inconsistent with the spell name or the general rules, but are otherwise free to try anything.

Prerequisites: Casting a spell requires a Spell written in a Spellbook. You must say the magic words loudly and precisely. Later, once you have learned the spell (i.e. you are casting a “known spell”) you no longer need the book.

Spell Level: The Guide sets the Spell Level based on what you said you are trying to do. You must pay the Spell Level in Hearts to attempt the spell. *Use Arcana Hearts first.*

Roll for Control: Ask the Oracle if you controlled the spell. On YES: you did, but on NO: you did not.

The Guide sets the Oracle target number based on the situation. This does not usually involve the spell level or caster level.

Effects: The Guide will describe your spell effects (or may offer to let you do this yourself).

If you controlled the spell it should largely do what you wanted. If you did not control the spell, then something else happens, ranging from different effects, collateral damage, or backlash damage to you. You can mitigate the risks by leaving a safety buffer between the spell level and your caster level. Sweet/Spicy add a twist.

Caster Level

Your caster level is your level of Alignment with the magic school of the spell. This determines your level of magic literacy and the maximum spell level you can safely attempt. For example, if your Umbrakalla level is 3 then you can safely cast Umbrakalla spells of 3rd level or lower.

When casting a spell from a spellbook or Arcana, treat your caster level as 1 level higher.

Alignment

To find your Alignment, count all relevant Advancements (Traits, Skills, Names, etc.) and divide by 3, rounding down. For example, if you have an Umbrakalla skill and know 6 Umbrakalla spells, you are a 2nd level Umbrakalla caster.

The Guide might ask for your Alignment to things other than magic schools or spells.

Learning Spells

Once you have cast a spell with Sweet, you are eligible to learn the spell. (See [Experience](#).) When casting a known spell you do not need a spellbook, although it still helps.

Arcana

An Arcana is a drippy spellbook. They can be any kind of item (not just books) as long as they have heavy magic-user "drip". The spells are written in stylized words of power rather than overly wordy novellas. Even tattoos are possible. To other people they appear like some kind of "wizard fashion statement".

Using Arcana

Arcana are used as spellbooks, which is significant since spellbooks provide a +1 bonus to caster level. They are favored by travelling magic-users, since they are generally more portable and durable than spellbooks..

Arcana Hearts

Arcana also provide "Arcana Hearts", which you can use as Hearts against magic. You can use Arcana Hearts when casting spells or when hit by hostile magic. Arcana Hearts are only available if the item was in your inventory slots at Muster, which limits which Arcana you can use for the day.

Creating Arcana

You can create an Arcana by transferring a *known spell* from a spellbook to an item. This costs 3 XP and 1d6 x 100 gp in materials.

The *power words* from the spell vanish from the book and appear on the item. The spellbook can no longer be used to cast that spell. In theory this can be reversed to restore the book, if all goes well.

Magic Components

Magic components are raw Arcana that provide Arcana Hearts but not spells. *Magic components can be found in strange magical places.*



Arcana vs Magic Items

Arcana are magic items only usable by magic-users. The arts of creating magic items usable by anyone else are long lost, but it seems likely that they started out as Arcana.

Vitae

Life force, growth, and harmony.
The magic of the Elves, written in living ink that grows and changes like vines. The hallow channel beneficial energies, promote growth, and keep nature's balance.

- 1.1** *Animal Bond* - form lasting connection
- 1.2** *Animal Friendship* - benevolent control
- 1.3** *Balance Weave* - unite opposites
- 1.4** *Beast Bond* - create long-lasting bond
- 1.5** *Beast Form* - friendly transformation
- 1.6** *Beast Speech* - talk with animals

- 2.1** *Divine Grace* - channel blessing
- 2.2** *Healing Touch* - cure wounds
- 2.3** *Joy Song* - lift spirits
- 2.4** *Life Bloom* - encourage growth
- 2.5** *Light Shield* - protect from evil
- 2.6** *Pacify* - remove violence

- 3.1** *Peace Aura* - calm violence
- 3.2** *Snail Knight* - summon noble mount
- 3.3** *Star Guide* - find true path
- 3.4** *Sun Beam* - channel daylight
- 3.5** *Thicket* - grow healthy plants
- 3.6** *Truth Sight* - see through lies

- 4.1** *Ward* - create protective barrier
- 4.2** *Cure Disease* - remove ailments
- 4.3** *Forest Touch* - speak with plants
- 4.4** *Growing Script* - living magical writing
- 4.5** *Nature's Blessing* - enhance

vitality

4.6 *Purification* - remove toxins

5.1 *Regeneration* - speed natural healing

5.2 *Heart Glyph* - inscribe emotions

5.3 *Nature's Bounty* - create food/water

5.4 *Pack Call* - summon animal allies

5.5 *Vital Surge* - boost life force

5.6 *Wild Empathy* - share animal feelings

6.1 *Life Transfer* - share vital force

6.2 *Nature's Rhythm* - align with cycles

6.3 *Perfect Unity* - complete balance

6.4 *Season's Call* - control growth cycle

6.5 *Tranquil Heart* - create inner peace

6.6 *Vital Harmony* - balance life forces

Elementale

Primal forces, elements, and weather. The Baal inscribe dragon magic in burning runes carved in stone. Practitioners control weather, create barriers of ice and fire, command gravity, and shape elements.

- 1.1** *Control Weather* - command climate
- 1.2** *Crystal Growth* - form gems
- 1.3** *Dragon's Breath* - channel flame
- 1.4** *Earth Shape* - mold stone
- 1.5** *Earthquake* - shake ground
- 1.6** *Element Master* - complete control

- 2.1** *Elemental Wall* - create barrier
- 2.2** *Fire Shield* - protective flames
- 2.3** *Fog Cloud* - create mist
- 2.4** *Force Wall* - energy barrier
- 2.5** *Gravity Shift* - change gravity
- 2.6** *Heat Metal* - make objects burning

- 3.1** *Icy Touch* - spread ice
- 3.2** *Increase Gravity* - triple weight
- 3.3** *Lightning Strike* - call electricity
- 3.4** *Liquid Air* - make air swimmable
- 3.5** *Mist Form* - become vapor
- 3.6** *Mountain's Strength* - earth power

- 4.1** *Rain Make* - create downpour
- 4.2** *Sculpt Elements* - shape materials
- 4.3** *Steam Form* - become vapor
- 4.4** *Stone Skin* - harden flesh

- 4.5** *Stone Tell* - read earth memories

- 4.6** *Storm Call* - summon thunder

- 5.1** *Summon Cube* - control earth

- 5.2** *Summon Idol* - create statue

- 5.3** *Thunder Call* - create sonic boom

- 5.4** *Tide Control* - command waters

- 5.5** *Upwell* - create spring

- 5.6** *Water Breathing* - breathe liquid

- 6.1** *Water Shape* - control liquid

- 6.2** *Web Weave* - spin natural nets

- 6.3** *Whirlwind* - create vortex

- 6.4** *Wind Shield* - air protection

- 6.5** *Wind Walk* - float on breeze

- 6.6** *Zephyr* - ride the winds

Thaumaturgy

Physical laws, mechanisms, and force. The engineering magic of the Dwur, written in foundational runes that command reality. Practitioners control objects, manipulate energy, bind powers, and impose their will upon matter.

- 1.1** *Adhere* - make sticky
- 1.2** *Animate Object* - objects obey
- 1.3** *Astral Prison* - crystal stasis
- 1.4** *Command* - force obedience
- 1.5** *Elasticity* - control form
- 1.6** *Filch* - teleport items

- 2.1** *Force Push* - directional power
- 2.2** *Haste* - control speed
- 2.3** *Hover* - control levitation
- 2.4** *Invisible Tether* - bind objects
- 2.5** *Knock* - open locks
- 2.6** *Leap* - control jumping

- 3.1** *Lock* - seal door
- 3.2** *Magic Suppressor* - null magic
- 3.3** *Masterscript* - write command runes
- 3.4** *Shrink Item* - reduce size
- 3.5** *Sort* - organize items
- 3.6** *Spider Climb* - control climbing

- 4.1** *Strengthen* - reinforce material
- 4.2** *Teleport* - move objects
- 4.3** *Time Slip* - control time
- 4.4** *Unravel* - counter spells
- 4.5** *Augment Object* - enhance item
- 4.6** *Control Device* - command mechanisms

- 5.1** *Animate Tool* - give purpose
- 5.2** *Binding Circle* - contain force
- 5.3** *Density Control* - alter mass
- 5.4** *Enhance Power* - boost magic
- 5.5** *Mend* - repair objects
- 5.6** *Object Memory* - read item history

- 6.1** *Reality Anchor* - stabilize space
- 6.2** *Rune Lock* - seal with power
- 6.3** *Shape Material* - change form
- 6.4** *Magic Circle* - create workspace
- 6.5** *Thaumaturgic Seal* - master rune
- 6.6** *Perfect Control* - complete mastery

Illusione

Perception, thought, and dreams.
The subtle magic of the Belerions,
woven from phantasmal scripts that
deceive the senses. Illusionists
create illusions, alter memories,
influence minds, and bend
perceived reality.

- 1.1** *Arcane Eye* - flying sensor
- 1.2** *Auditory Illusion* - create sounds
- 1.3** *Bewitch* - enchant mind
- 1.4** *Blur* - distort appearance
- 1.5** *Charm* - create friendship
- 1.6** *Detect Magic* - see magic

- 2.1** *Disguise* - alter appearance
- 2.2** *Dream Message* - send sleeping visions
- 2.3** *Dream Walking* - enter dreams
- 2.4** *Duplicate* - create copies
- 2.5** *Emotional Aura* - project feeling
- 2.6** *False Memory* - plant fake memory

- 3.1** *Feign Death* - appear dead
- 3.2** *Greed* - create obsession
- 3.3** *Hypnotize* - question trance
- 3.4** *Illusory Spray* - disorient with light
- 3.5** *Invisibility* - become unseen
- 3.6** *Mass Suggestion* - group command

- 4.1** *Major Image* - perfect illusion
- 4.2** *Mind Maze* - trap thoughts
- 4.3** *Mind Shield* - protect thoughts
- 4.4** *Mirror Image* - create duplicates
- 4.5** *Mirror Walk* - step through glass

- 4.6** *Perfect Illusion* - undetectable fake

- 5.1** *Phantom Sound* - distant noise

- 5.2** *Phantasmal Force* - moving illusion

- 5.3** *Programmed Illusion* - triggered effect

- 5.4** *Read Mind* - hear thoughts

- 5.5** *Scry* - share vision

- 5.6** *Silent Image* - create scene

- 6.1** *Spectacle* - create grand illusion

- 6.2** *Telepathy* - project thoughts

- 6.3** *True Seeing* - pierce deception

- 6.4** *Vision* - personal illusion

- 6.5** *Visual Illusion* - static images

- 6.6** *X-Ray Vision* - see through matter

Umbrakallo

Shadows, thresholds, and dimensional paths. The secret magic of the Alu, written in darkness and void. Practitioners create Kalla gates, walk between shadows, craft dimensional spaces, and traverse the boundaries between realms.

- 1.1** *Befuddle* - shadow memories
- 1.2** *Body Swap* - shadow exchange
- 1.3** *Cloak of Shadows* - dark protection
- 1.4** *Dark Anchor* - fix dimensional point
- 1.5** *Darksight* - see in darkness
- 1.6** *Deep Shadow* - create pure darkness

- 2.1** *Dimension Door* - create portal
- 2.2** *Disassemble* - shadow-split form
- 2.3** *Gate Sense* - detect portals
- 2.4** *Hatred* - dark emotion
- 2.5** *Ice Heart* - freeze with shadow
- 2.6** *Kalla Gate* - create pocket realm

- 3.1** *Kallascript* - write gate runes
- 3.2** *Masquerade* - shadow dance
- 3.3** *Miniaturize* - shrink into shadows
- 3.4** *Mind Shatter* - shadow thoughts
- 3.5** *Night Sphere* - create darkness
- 3.6** *Nightmare Seed* - dark dreams

- 4.1** *Ooze Form* - shadow substance
- 4.2** *Phantom Coach* - shadow transport
- 4.3** *Plane Shift* - change reality
- 4.4** *Realm Weave* - connect spaces

4.5 *Shadow Bind* - trap in darkness

4.6 *Shadow Clone* - create dark duplicate

5.1 *Shadow Meld* - merge with darkness

5.2 *Shadow Step* - travel through dark

5.3 *Shadow Time* - pause in darkness

5.4 *Shuffle* - shadow displacement

5.5 *Smoke Form* - become shadow

5.6 *Space Fold* - bend dimensions

6.1 *Threshold Walk* - pass through doors

6.2 *Twilight Veil* - walk between worlds

6.3 *Void Gate* - open dark portal

6.4 *Void Shield* - dark protection

6.5 *Void Step* - brief teleport

6.6 *Perfect Shadow* - complete control

Necromantia

Death, spirits, and decay. The forbidden magic of the Avathars, inscribed in blood and bone. Practitioners bind spirits, animate dead, drain life force, and manipulate the boundary between life and death.

- 1.1** *Animate Skeleton* - raise bones
- 1.2** *Black Sacrament* - death ritual
- 1.3** *Blood Curse* - sacrifice life
- 1.4** *Blood Track* - follow wounds
- 1.5** *Bone Puppet* - animate dead
- 1.6** *Bone Shield* - skeletal armor

- 2.1** *Command Undead* - control dead
- 2.2** *Comprehend Dead* - dead languages
- 2.3** *Corpse Explosion* - detonate dead
- 2.4** *Dark Blessing* - death's power
- 2.5** *Death Gate* - portal to underworld
- 2.6** *Death Touch* - wither life

- 3.1** *Death Ward* - protect from necrotic
- 3.2** *Doom Mark* - mark for death
- 3.3** *Drain Life* - steal vitality
- 3.4** *Fear Aura* - death terror
- 3.5** *Ghost Bind* - trap spirits
- 3.6** *Grave Mist* - create death fog

- 4.1** *Life Sense* - detect living
- 4.2** *Mass Animation* - raise army
- 4.3** *Marble Madness* - death's toys
- 4.4** *Pain Echo* - share suffering
- 4.5** *Plague Wind* - spread death

4.6 *Psychometry* - read death echoes

- 5.1** *Raise Dead* - create undead
- 5.2** *Sniff* - smell death
- 5.3** *Soul Cage* - trap essence
- 5.4** *Soul Rend* - tear spirit
- 5.5** *Speak with Dead* - question spirits
- 5.6** *Spirit Chains* - bind ghost

- 6.1** *Spirit Form* - become ghostly
- 6.2** *Truth Sense* - death's truth
- 6.3** *Undead Sight* - see spirits
- 6.4** *Vampiric Touch* - drain energy
- 6.5** *Wizard Mark* - death runes
- 6.6** *Perfect Death* - ultimate end

Canting

The art of deception and manipulation. Spoken in Thieves' Cant, the secret language of thieves, written in flash papers and brotherhood marks. If you can't flash the patter, best stay out of the Darkmans.

1.1 *Mark the Gull* - spot easy marks

1.2 *Cony-Catch* - sense fears/vices

1.3 *Budge* - distance unlock

1.4 *Juke* - dodge attack

1.5 *Mort's Mask* - change face

1.6 *Flash Paper* - hidden messages

2.1 *Foist* - pickpocket from afar

2.2 *Nip* - summon loose object

2.3 *Second-Story Man* - sure climb

2.4 *Fleet Pad* - quickened step

2.5 *Darkmans Cloak* - shadow invisibility

2.6 *Spring* - enhanced leap

3.1 *Upright Man's Word* - command street folk

3.2 *Brotherhood Mark* - sense guild members

3.3 *Budge Barrel* - conceal goods

3.4 *Rum Dubber* - master lockpick

3.5 *Rearward Glim* - spot followers

3.6 *Dog's Leg* - tail undetected

4.1 *Maze Whispers* - distant eavesdrop

4.2 *Perfect Mort* - full impersonation

4.3 *Ken Miller* - break into any building

4.4 *Mizzle* - vanish when spotted

4.5 *Topping Cove* - cross rooftops

4.6 *Sharper's Nose* - sniff out weakness

5.1 *Rum Mort* - false identity

5.2 *Blood Brotherhood* - compel loyalty for job

5.3 *Mill the Watch* - silence sentry

5.4 *Rum Ken* - find safehouse

5.5 *Darkmans Veil* - unseen in crowds

5.6 *Many Faces* - shift personas

6.1 *Dimber Damber's Web* - silent signals

6.2 *Bulk the Watch* - distract guards

6.3 *Deathless Brotherhood* - speak with dead thieves

6.4 *Darkmans Twin* - shadow twin

6.5 *Jarkman's Gift* - living forgeries

6.6 *Prince of Thieves* - inspire loyalty

Sentient Items

Sentient items contain a bound soul of a magic-user, elemental, *djinn*, *ifrit*, *kha'din*, dragon, eldar, deep one, or other entity. Bound spirits are notoriously capricious, jealous, and unhinged from confinement, their original dreams and ambitions maybe twisted by madness.

Sentient items almost always have magic powers. Some powers might be similar to normal magic items. Others might only reveal themselves with attunement.

Sentient items are temperamental; when you first attempt to use one, ask the Oracle if the item **accepts** you. On Sweet or Spicy, the item also talks to you!

If you carry a sentient item, your character grows in *Alignment* and may discover deeper mysteries. You should take Traits that reflect this growing attachment. For example, you might take a Trait such as "Wielder of Duskbringer". It's petty, but they *hate* anyone who offends their fragile egos, such as carrying them after being rejected, refusing to follow their agenda, abandoning, or "cheating" on them with a rival item.



Invocations

You can make an Invocation to an otherworldly being by loudly and formally calling their True Name *thrice* and making a request.

Lore

Look for True Names in mythic places, written on runestones, tombs, or magic amulets. Randomly generate each new name; beings can have many names. You might want to ask the Oracle “have I heard this *Name* before?”, “is this being aligned with Law?”, etc. All this adds to the known Lore of the *being*.

Making a Request

An Invocation is a request for a boon or curse. This should include a valuable offering such as Hearts or better. Ask the Oracle if the being responds to your request. On Sweet they *like* the request, on Spicy they *dislike* it.

An Answer?

The Guide follows existing Lore to interpret the answer, and will likely ask the Oracle what the being does (if anything) and when, how, etc. The Guide will consider the personality of the being, Alignment of your character, and the offering. All of these may affect or limit the scope of effect.

The workings of otherworldly beings are often mysterious. They may

interpret your request from a different perspective, and may have a different sense of time.



TWO BRIGHT FORMS MET HIM

Alignment

Making an Invocation changes your character. The being will grant you a Trait that brings you into Alignment with *them*. You immediately gain this Trait and must pay 3 XP before any other advancements are possible. Other demands are possible.

Relics

A Relic is a sacred object that serves as conduit to an otherworldly being. Relics act much like *Sentient Items*, and are often mistaken for magic items or as “cursed” magic items.

Fighting

In each Round, you can Move and Attack (or take another action).

Move

You can stand up OR move 40 feet (20 feet with Baggage). Each impediment (e.g. readying weapons, bad terrain, darkness) cuts this in half.

Attack

Ask the Oracle if you "hit"; this deals d6 Hearts. More lethal weapons may have a damage bonus, e.g. "greatsword +1".

Defend

When you are attacked or otherwise endangered, ask the Oracle if you avoid getting "hit". If you are hit, the Guide rolls Hearts lost (often d6).

Reduce melee damage by 1 Heart if you melee attack or parry that foe this round.

Armor and shields give 1 "iron" Heart per item slot, usable only against weapons. More protective items may have a bonus, such as "shield +1".



Initiative

The Guide determines the order in which players and foes act each round. This can be simultaneous.

- Characters in front are usually called on before the rear.
- Melee attacks go before ranged attacks, even if they need to move into range before attacking.
- Attackers are open to immediate (often simultaneous) counterattacks.
- When approaching from a distance the weapon with the better reach (by item slots) has "right of way" to go first.
- In close quarters combat (under 10 feet of space per person) the smaller weapon has "right of way" to go first.
- Non-weapon actions such as spells are resolved last.

Monsters

Each monster (or trap, etc.) has a **Level** comparable to **Character Level**. The Guide sets the Oracle to "hard" if this is higher than Character Level; or "easy" if lower. Consider using the party leader's level when working together.

- Lvl 0:** giant rat, vermin, goblin
- Lvl 1:** orc, skeleton, deathskito
- Lvl 2:** zombie, ghoul, big bug, slime
- Lvl 3:** wight, harpy, giant spider
- Lvl 4:** werewolf, ogre, huge slime
- Lvl 5:** mummy, minotaur, owlbeast
- Lvl 6:** troll, wyvern, manticores
- Lvl 7:** griffon, djinni, vampire
- Lvl 9:** chimera, giant
- Lvl 10:** golem, dragon

For more detail, the Guide can use OSR monsters or wing it as follows.

Pack/tribal monsters have d6 Hearts and deal d6 damage per hit; leaders have double.

A solitary "apex predator" monster has 2d6 or 3d6 Hearts per HD, multiple attacks, plus a deadly attack of 2d6 or 3d6, or d6 Hearts per Round for HD Turns (for paralysis, poison, petrification, etc).

Death

Characters and monsters die at 0 Hearts. If you reach 0 Hearts, choose whether you die "offscreen" or "onscreen".

Offscreen: We cut away as your character drops; bring in another character next round. Offscreen deaths are uncertain. At any future Muster, you may let the character pass on, or make an Invocation to return. On **Double Spicy** (double 1s) you are dead with no uncertainty.

Onscreen: Describe one final heroic action on the next round; ask the Oracle if the action succeeds and then go Offscreen. *Heroic feats require Sweet. Spicy indicates immediate, final death*



Quick Reference

Insight

1. Trait
2. Skill
3. Item
4. Name
5. Morale
6. Effort

Alignment

To find your Alignment, count all relevant Advancements (Traits, Skills, Names, etc.) and divide by 3, rounding down. For example, if you have an Umbrakalla skill and know 6 Umbrakalla spells, you are a 2nd level Umbrakalla caster.

The Guide might ask for your Alignment to things other than magic schools or spells.